

# A Green Path to Responsible Productions

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## ABSTRACT

This talk will focus on the design process of a green studio in the center of Paris, covering the various stages of reflection that led to its construction. Together, we will explore how it fits into TeamTO's historical CSR trajectory before delving into the technical choices that were implemented. We will examine it from the perspectives of energy considerations and carbon footprint (including discussing how to calculate it), as well as TeamTO's efforts to optimize our pipeline throughout our history.

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## 1 A GREEN STUDIO AND SUSTAINABLE PRACTICES

In November 2022, TeamTO moved into its new, green studio in the Bastille district of Paris. This cutting-edge facility is the result of 17 years of maturing Corporate Social Responsibility at TeamTO. In particular, it seeks to answer the question: **"How can we produce great 3D animation in an eco-responsible way?"**

Since the creation in 2009 of the first carbon calculator for animation, this question has challenged the studio's brain trust. We have always emphasized the quality and efficiency of our production pipeline throughout the years of growth. The problem of energy efficiency is commonly posed as one of trade-offs. But we refused to assume our core mission was incompatible with extreme energy efficiency.

Seriously: How can we produce great 3D animation in an eco-responsible way? First and foremost, by asking the question of the deep realities of a studio's carbon costs. As a pioneer in the industry on the subject, TeamTO carried out its first carbon assessment in 2009. Aware that the problem affects everyone, we started a workgroup in the union AnimFrance to create a free, open-source calculator for the global animation industry.

These carbon costs follow directly from our technological choices. Power, air conditioning (is it actually needed by the way?), Server Room cooling, remote work solutions: for all of these items, TeamTO provides, as we will see, an optimal response according to the calculation grids supplied by the French Agency for Ecological

Transition, or according to our own algorithms when we have chosen to push analytical rationality to the level of our requirements.

Providing an optimal response to these component problems requires the identification of the best services, but this is not sufficient. It is also necessary to be certain, through a continuous improvement mechanism, that the energy economy resists the entropy brought about by the daily modifications of the production contexts and the environment. This is the resolutely experimental next challenge for the studio.

Finally, the studio's ambition of eco-responsibility is also fed **by its production methods and corporate culture**. What is the point of optimizing energy if we are obliged - for reasons of a suboptimal pipeline - to recalculate several times the images produced and then consume as many times the necessary energy? Theoretical computer science allows us to show how the technical strategy of the studio pipeline embraces **information, energy, and economic cost** in the same vision.

This is usually the "good news" at the end of the day: eco-responsibility is absolutely compatible - provided that the methods and maturity are right - with the studio's qualitative AND economic ambitions. This principle remains definitely central in TeamTO's perspective and can be shared with other studios willing to take a greener way.

## 2 FEW WORDS ABOUT TEAMTO:

We develop and produce original content for television and cinema and we work with some producers on their own projects. We are determined to give priority to projects that make sense and to ensure that our images have a strong impact on the audience.

Since the creation of TeamTO in 2005 we have produced the original series such as *BehindtheBeats* (for France Télévisions and YouTube Originals), *JadeArmor* (with France Télévisions, Super RTL et HBO Max), *AngeloRules* (5 seasons), *Emmy@nominated*, or even *Presto!SchoolofMagic*, *MightyMike*, *MyKnightandMe*, *Oscar'sOasis* and the feature film *Yellowbird*.

We produce as work-for-hire major TV series such as: *eOne's PJMasks*, *RickyZoom* and *Kiya*, *Silvergate's TheCreatureCases*, *Netflix's City of Ghosts*, *Activision Blizzard's SkylandersAcademy*, *Ubisoft's RabbidsInvasion*, *Disney's SofiaTheFirst* and *ElenaOfAvalor*; among many others.

The company's two French studios with over 400 artists are based in Paris and Valence, with offices in Beijing, Toronto and Los Angeles. We have produced 400+ hours of animation in the last 17 years.

We are committed to a 50/50 model within our teams. Our management level is equally split between men and women. We also have actively implemented anti-harassment policies in the studio. Corinne Kouper, one of the founders of TeamTO is the President and co-founder of "LesFemmess' Animent" (LFA), the French Women in Animation, since 2014.

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In 2018, we launched the ECAS France's first ever comprehensive free animation program at the world-renowned Cartoucherie campus in Bourg-lès-Valence, near one of TeamTO's own studios. After 4 successful years training promising French students in the

field of CG animation, TeamTO and House of Cool expanded the curriculum to include a course on Storyboarding in 2021. The next course ECAS is very excited about is a dubbing course.